AI ADVISOR & FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · SENIOR IT TRANSFORMATION LEADER

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IT transformation leader with more than thirty years of experience in the private and public sectors. Today I advise organizations on AI. As a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), I also build together with the client. I do this under my own brand, Fender ICT · AI Advisory.

33+	**20**	**16**
years in IT, since April 1993	employers and clients	certifications earned

Profile

I lead change in organizations that cannot afford mistakes: banks, insurers and government. I operate where technology, governance and risk meet. I have worked on projects in public cloud, in security, and today also in AI.

My background is program management. I translate strategic objectives into a multi-year roadmap, a budget and a team that knows what to do. Working as an FDE asks for more. I know the rules for security and privacy, and I speak the language of the IT department. I work out the business case and involve right from the start the people who will eventually use the solution.

Since late 2025 I have also been building solutions myself, with the help of AI. Preliminary work that used to take weeks now takes days. That leaves more time for consultation, eventually resulting in a better output.

AI Advisory

Advice	**AI advice** Together with management, I look at where AI fits, where it does not and what it may do. I also check how it stays within the rules for security, privacy and audit.
Co-creation	**Forward Deployed Engineer** A Forward Deployed Engineer does not work from a distance, but on site at the client. I build until the solution works and teach the team to use it.
Experience	**More than an engineer** A good Forward Deployed Engineer combines strategy, budget, IT and security, change management and software. I built up that combination over thirty years, in many sectors.
Approach	**Rules and numbers first** I start with the rules. What may AI do, under the regulations and within what the IT department allows? Then I look at the numbers. What does a task cost today, and what does AI deliver?

First client

Puur Reizen

For a travel agency, I set up a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business together with the team. They now work consistently with their own tone of voice, house style and house rules.

What I built with AI

2025 – 2026

Working software, built by me with the help of AI.

2025 – present

Own project

Personal AI operating system

My own AI working environment, which I built and use every day.

- A growing library of skills, a memory system and AI agents I configure myself, for research, software and documentation.
- Works with Claude Code and with Codex, with the same skills on both sides.

Technology: Claude Code, Codex, Python, JavaScript, Markdown

Oct 2026 – present

Puur Reizen

Customer portal and back office for Puur Reizen

Brings customers, trips, documents and invoices together in one place for a travel agency.

- Customers request a trip, see their own trips and invoices, and upload their travel documents themselves.
- The agency follows every trip by status, raises deposit and balance invoices, and sees requests, revenue and upcoming departures in reports.
- Status changes are proposals that a staff member confirms. Staff sign in with their Microsoft account.
- The data stays with the agency, with an open API, exports and webhooks. An AI application gets read-only access by default.

Technology: TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Microsoft Entra ID, REST API

Jul 2026

Smals

Resource Capacity Planner

One shared, live view of which teams are stretched and which are not.

- Sets operational load against project work for **some forty technical teams**. It works at three levels, from team lead and division head to the Office of the CTO.
- From data model to live dashboards, running in production on Google Cloud.
- Replaced a set of manually maintained spreadsheets that nobody fully trusted.

Technology: Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Apr 2026

Smals

Automated NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals evidence factory

Compliance evidence for NIS-2 and the CCB's CyberFundamentals, collected automatically.

- Pulls configuration and control data from dozens of operational systems through their APIs and turns it into audit-ready reporting.
- **Weeks of manual work before every audit** became a repeatable run.
- I handled the source research, defined the data model, and did most of the engineering and the testing myself, all with the help of AI agents.

Technology: Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Sharing knowledge

2018 – 2026

Teaching, presenting and helping others get started.

Oct 2026	**Je hebt 2 jaar: AI for knowledge workers** One-day hands-on training I designed and gave. Participants built their own working AI operating system around one recurring task, from context engineering to automation. On 23 October 2026.
Sep 2026	**AI Team Day: GitHub Copilot Enterprise for team leads** Smals · One-day hands-on training for the team leads of the Infrastructure Fabric & Operations Services division. I designed it and gave it together with a colleague. Every team lead built their own AI workspace around a recurring task of their choice. On 4 September 2026.
2023 – 2026	**Info sessions on public cloud and security** Smals · For the member institutions of social security and the federal government, often to large audiences.
2018 – 2021	**IT reporting for franchisees** Burger Brands Belgium · Regular presentations of IT achievements and the related costs at franchisee board meetings and regional meetings.

Expertise

What I know and use, grouped by domain.

Leadership and programs	Program and portfolio management · steering committees and reporting to C-level executives · budgets, CAPEX and OPEX · FinOps · suppliers and public tenders · teams of up to 25 people · interim IT management
Security and compliance	ISO 27001/27002 · ISAE 3402 · NIS-2 · CCB CyberFundamentals · NIST CSF · C2M2 · OWASP SAMM and ASVS · COBIT · GDPR · post-quantum cryptography
Cloud and infrastructure	Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · landing zones · Entra ID · VMware · Citrix · Red Hat OpenShift · Windows Server and Active Directory · SAN and NAS
AI and automation	AI agents and agentic workflows · Claude Code · Codex · Claude Team · ChatGPT Business · LLM pilots · context engineering · Python · automated compliance evidence

Methods	PRINCE2 · ITIL v3 · DEMO · Scrum · PMBOK · BPMN · Cloud Adoption Framework
Tools	Jira · Confluence · Sciforma · ServiceNow · CA Clarity · HP PPM · Power BI · M365

Languages

Dutch	Native.
French	Bilingual. Four years of study in France (Angers and Paris) and the Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires.
English	Full professional proficiency. Studied in Leeds and the daily working language in international programs.

Personality

Mar 2019	**Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI): ISFJ** MBTI profile, European edition (OPP) · Taken on 20 March 2019. ISFJ stands for Introversion, Sensing, Feeling and Judging. In plain words, I prefer quiet focus and start from concrete facts. I keep an eye on the people who will work with the result. And I like a plan and commitments that are kept.

References and recommendations available on request.